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**The situation in the temporarily occupied territories of
Ukraine**

**Promotion and protection of human rights: human rights
situations and reports of special rapporteurs and
representatives**

Letter dated 28 November 2022 from the Chargé d'affaires a.i. of the Permanent Mission of Ukraine to the United Nations addressed to the Secretary-General

I have the honour to enclose herewith the comment of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Ukraine on the so-called “sentences” issued to the Ukrainian citizen journalists Arifmemetov, Suleimanov and Sheykhaliyev and activists Muedinov and Ametov of 25 November 2022 (see annex).

I would appreciate your kind assistance in having the present letter and its annex distributed as a document of the General Assembly, under agenda items 59 and 68 (c), and of the Security Council.

(Signed) Khrystyna **Hayovyshyn**
Chargé d'affaires a.i.



**Annex to the letter dated 28 November 2022 from the Chargé
d'affaires a.i. of the Permanent Mission of Ukraine to the
United Nations addressed to the Secretary-General**

**Comment of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Ukraine on the
so-called “sentences” issued to the Ukrainian citizen journalists
Arifmemetov, Suleimanov and Sheykhaliyev and activists
Muedinov and Ametov**

25 November 2022 13:03

The Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Ukraine strongly condemns the shameful sentences of the occupation authorities in Crimea, issued to Ukrainian citizen journalists Osman Arifmemetov, Ruslan Suleymanov and Rustem Sheykhaliyev, as well as to activists Yashar Muedinov and Enver Ametov.

Osman Arifmemetov, Ruslan Suleymanov and Rustem Sheykhaliyev were sentenced to 14 years in prison. Yashar Muedinov and Enver Ametov were sentenced to 13 years in prison.

The total term of imprisonment of Crimean political prisoners is approaching 1300 years.

In March 2019, citizen journalists were illegally detained on trumped-up charges of organizing and participating in the alleged activities of a terrorist organization and preparing for a violent seizure of power. All these years, they were under severe pressure from the judicial system of the Russian Federation, the methods of which are torture and psychological pressure. Their imprisonment became a traditional revenge for the pro-Ukrainian position and opposition to the Russian occupation of Crimea.

These shameful sentences are a show of strength where there is none, and yet another manifestation of the disregard for basic human rights.

The Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Ukraine calls on the international community and our partners on the International Crimea Platform to continue exerting political, diplomatic, sanctions and economic pressure on Russia in order to immediately release all Ukrainian citizens illegally imprisoned by the Putin regime.

Ukrainian diplomats will continue to fight for the release of each and every illegally imprisoned citizen of Ukraine, including by drawing maximum attention to the fate of political prisoners through the initiative of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Ukraine of public advocacy mentoring citizen journalists illegally imprisoned by the Russian Federation.
